



disney land northern california mid 1980's it's a small world ride

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Disneyland's "It's a Small World" in the Mid-1980s

In the mid-1980s, **Disneyland's "It's a Small World"** was still one of the park's most iconic and beloved attractions, having opened in 1966 after its debut at the 1964–65 New York World's Fair [Wikipedia +1](#) . By the 1980s, it had become a staple of Fantasyland, celebrated for its **300+ Audio-Animatronic dolls** from around the globe, each singing the Sherman Brothers' theme song in their native language [Wikipedia +1](#) .

Visual and Thematic Style

The ride's **Finale room** had undergone a major change by the late 1970s. In 1979, the original white, silver, and gold sets were replaced with a **blue and purple color scheme**, a shift that was still visible in rare 1980 souvenir film footage [YouTube](#) . This version featured repainted set pieces, colored lights, and the same animated scenes of children from different cultures. The Tower of the Four Winds, a 120-foot mobile sculpture by Rolly Crump, remained a signature visual landmark [disneyparksblog.com](#) .

Scenes and Atmosphere

Guests traveled in 16-passenger boats through scenes representing regions like Scandinavia, Holland, Belgium, and more, each with its own costumes, music, and cultural details [YouTube](#) . The atmosphere was consistently cheerful, with a strong emphasis on **world peace and unity**, a theme that had been central since the ride's inception [Wikipedia +1](#) .

Cultural Context

By the mid-1980s, "It's a Small World" was not only a ride but also a **symbol of global connection**. It had been sponsored by the Bank of America since 1966 and was still a major draw for both children and adults [Coasterpedia](#) . The attraction's mix of music, animation, and cultural representation made it a unique blend of entertainment and education.

Rare Footage

For fans seeking a glimpse into its mid-1980s look, the **1980 "A Day at Disneyland" souvenir film** contains brief but valuable clips of the Finale room in its new blue/purple palette, plus scenes from the Europe and other regions [YouTube](#) . These are among the earliest surviving videos of that specific version.

In summary: In the mid-1980s, Disneyland's "It's a Small World" was a vibrant, colorful, and culturally rich boat ride, still in its original form but with the updated Finale room colors, continuing to celebrate global unity through music, animation, and storytelling.

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W Wikipedia

It's a Small World - Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/It%27s_a_Small_World

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It's a Small World (Disneyland Park) - Coasterpedia

https://coasterpedia.net/wiki/It%27s_a_Small_World_%28Disneyland_Park%29

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The Original "It's A Small World at Disneyland" 1987 - YouTube

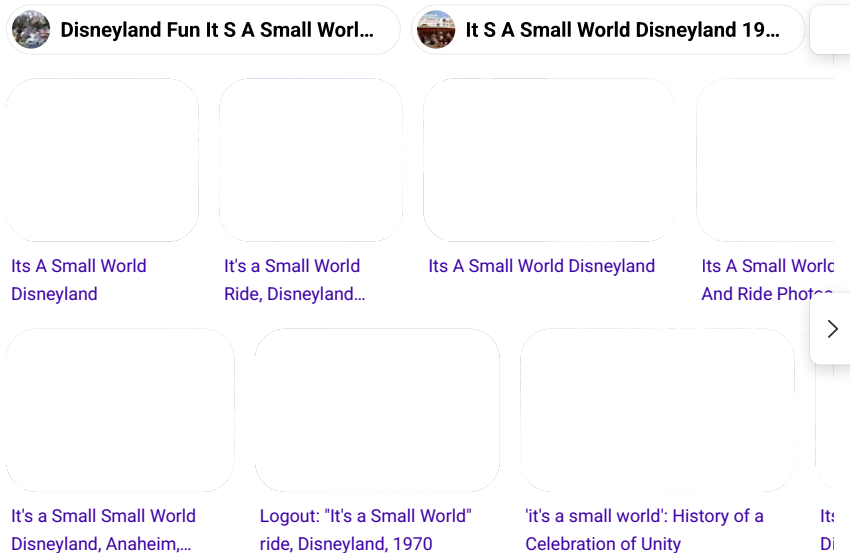


Jul 6, 2026 · This VHS video was shot in 1987, so it shows the attraction as it was originally presented and it stands on it's own.



Author: MDS Presents! Views: 1.6K

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It's a Small World - Wikipedia

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It's a Small World (stylized in all lowercase and in quotations or with an exclamation mark) is an Old Mill boat ride located in the Fantasyland area at various Disney theme parks around the world. Versions of the ride are installed at Disneyland in Anaheim, California; Magic Kingdom in Bay Lake, Florida; Tokyo Disneyland; Disneyland Park (Paris) and Hong Kong Disneyland. The inaugural version of the ride premiered at the



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YouTube
https://www.youtube.com

"it's a small world" Disneyland extremely rare 1980 official ... - YouTube



Jan 21, 2023 · This is a reupload of the rare footage of "it's a small world" from the 1980 souvenir film, A Day at Disneyland. This footage is extremely rare and cool because it's one of the...
Author: Benjamin Roberson Views: 4.4K

Business Insider
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Vintage Photos of Disneyland - Business Insider

Jun 21, 2018 · However, many oldies have been proven goodies, and adults who visited the park as kids can bring their own families and see many of the same attractions they used to, like "It's A Small...

Coasterpedia
https://coasterpedia.net › wiki

It's a Small World (Disneyland Park) - Coasterpedia

it's a small world is a Boat Ride / Dark Ride located at Disneyland Park in Anaheim, California, USA. Originally opening in 1964 at the 1964-1965 New York World's ...



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'It's a small world': History of a Celebration of Unity

Jul 25, 2024 · Many elements of "it's a small world" are still instantly recognizable today, like the popular clockwork art for the attraction's opening at Disneyland ...



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Disneyland It's a Small World Gallery of Photos - See California

As you ride in darkness through chambers inside a building you see the world lit up through animation dolls singing the "It's a Small World" song in various languages. Riders on this 15 minute boat trip ...



WDW News Today
<https://wdwnt.com>

Full History of "it's a small world" at Disney Parks Around the Globe

May 21, 2023 · Let's take a close look at "it's a small world" from its inception to its current state in multiple parks around the globe. We've broken down the full history of this iconic ride, the "happiest ...



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fandom.com
<https://disney.fandom.com/wiki>

It's a Small World | Disney Wiki | Fandom

Mar 11, 2015 · For the theme song of the same name, see It's a Small World (song).
It's a Small World, stylized as "it's a small world", is a water-based dark ride ...



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